

Moving-In Condition Report & Rights Checklist — South Australia

Get this right on day one — it protects your bond for the entire tenancy.

Correct as at July 2026. General information only, not legal advice.

Section 1 — Before You Sign the Lease

- ☐ ☐ **Confirm you're being given current, compliant prescribed forms** — SA's forms changed on 1 July 2024 and again on 1 September 2025; anything older may not comply with current Residential Tenancies Regulations 2025.
- ☐ ☐ **Ask about smoke alarm compliance** and any recent safety checks.
- ☐ ☐ **If you have a pet, understand your position.** Since 1 July 2024, SA tenants can, for the first time, have pets in rental homes — but this is subject to landlord approval and reasonable conditions the landlord can set (e.g. keeping the pet outside, or professional carpet cleaning at the end of the tenancy). Submit your request early and in writing.

Section 2 — The Condition Report Itself

- ☐ ☐ **Request the entry condition report** if not automatically provided.
- ☐ ☐ **Complete your own section thoroughly**, room by room.
- ☐ ☐ **Photograph everything**, especially existing wear, damage, or imperfections.
- ☐ ☐ **Note existing issues explicitly.**
- ☐ ☐ **Test everything that should work:** taps, toilets, switches, power points, stovetop, and any included appliances.
- ☐ ☐ **Submit your condition report within the required timeframe.**
- ☐ ☐ **Keep a copy for yourself** — you'll need it again at the end of your lease.

Section 3 — Ongoing Rights During Your Tenancy

- ☐ ☐ **Know your rent increase protections.** Rent can be increased only **once every 12 months**, with at least **60 days' written notice**.
- ☐ ☐ **Know no-grounds terminations have been abolished since 1 July 2024** — your landlord needs a valid, documented reason to end your tenancy.
- ☐ ☐ **Know about extended notice periods for some lease endings** — the 2024 reforms extended notice periods in various circumstances to give renters more time to find alternative housing.
- ☐ ☐ **Know about protections if you're experiencing domestic abuse** — the 2024 reforms specifically added extra options and protections for tenants in this situation; contact Consumer and Business Services SA or a support service for guidance if this applies to you.
- ☐ ☐ **Request repairs in writing** — this creates a paper trail if a dispute later needs to go to SACAT.

Section 4 — Red Flags at Move-In

- ☐ ☐ **A condition report with suspiciously few noted issues** on an older or clearly lived-in property.
- ☐ ☐ **Being pressured to sign before receiving the condition report or properly inspecting.**
- ☐ ☐ **Being asked for rent above the advertised price** — rent bidding has been banned in SA since April 2023.
- ☐ ☐ **Being handed outdated prescribed forms** — anything predating the 1 September 2025 forms update may not be compliant.

Quick Reference — SA Tenant Rights & Key Dates

REQUIREMENT	DETAIL
Major reform commencement	1 July 2024
Rent bidding ban	Since April 2023
No-grounds evictions	Abolished since 1 July 2024
Pets	Permitted subject to landlord approval and reasonable conditions
Rent increase	Once per 12 months, 60 days' notice
Latest prescribed forms	Updated 1 September 2025
Dispute resolution	SACAT

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